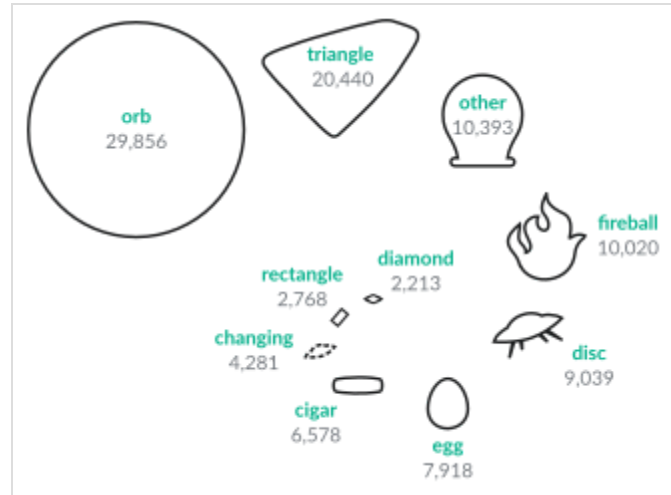




List of reported UFO sightings

This is a list of notable reported sightings of unidentified flying objects (UFOs) some of which include related claims of close encounters of the second or third kind or alien abduction. UFOs are generally considered to include any perceived aerial phenomenon that cannot be immediately identified or explained. Upon investigation, most UFOs are identified as known objects or atmospheric phenomena, while a small number remain unexplained.^{[2][3][4]} UFOs have been referred to using a range of terms including the more specific "flying saucer" and the more general term "unidentified anomalous phenomena" (UAP). "UAP" is sometimes used to avoid cultural associations with UFO conspiracy theories.^{[5][6][7]}

Although often viewed as abnormal, UFO sightings are reported frequently.^{[8][9]} During the United States' initial 1947 wave, over 800 sightings were reported in the news.^[10] The British Ministry of Defence receives hundreds of reports each year.^[11] In Brazil, pilots alone report dozens of annual sightings.^{[12][13]} A small portion of reported sightings have lasting cultural significance,^[14] interpreted through the cultural and technological expectations of the time.^[15]



Most commonly reported shapes in UFO sightings gathered in the National UFO Reporting Center (NUFORC) Online Database ^[1]

Antiquity

Date	Name	Location	Description
c. 1450 BC	<u>Tulli Papyrus</u> (<u>de Rachewiltz</u> 1953 ^[16])	<u>Ancient Egypt</u> ; <u>Jebel Barkal</u> , <u>Lower Egypt</u>	After a military campaign in Nubia, Thutmose III had a stele erected at the Temple of Amun, beneath the Jebel Barkal outcropping. ^[17] The stele describes how "a star came down" to set fire to Thutmose's adversaries. ^{[18][19]} This has been cited by Dr Condon ^[20] (<u>Condon Committee</u> ^[21]) via the purported <u>Tulli Papyrus</u> , likely a fraud. ^[20] This alleged translation—published in issue 41 of the Fortean Society's magazine <i>Doubt</i> —used such Fortean tropes as "circles of fire" and fish that "fell down from the sky". ^{[22]:369–372} The exact details of the papyrus is thought impossible to confirm due to transcription errors. ^[23]
218 BC	<u>Ships in the sky</u>	<u>Roman Republic</u> ; <u>Italia</u>	During the wintertime in the war between the Carthaginians and Rome, Livy recorded "portents", including <i>navium speciem de caelo adfulsisse</i> ("A phantom navy was seen shining in the sky" ^[24] "a spectacle of ships gleamed in the sky": ^[25] depending on the translation.)
76 BC	<u>Spark from a falling star</u>	<u>Roman Republic</u> ; <u>Asia</u>	According to Pliny the Elder, a spark fell from a star and grew as it descended until it appeared to be the size of the Moon. It then ascended and transformed into a torch. Astronomer <u>Richard Stothers</u> interpreted the report as a description of a bolide. ^{[26][27]}
73 BC	<u>Flame-like wine-jars from the sky</u>	<u>Roman Republic</u> ; <u>Phrygia</u> , <u>Asia</u>	According to Plutarch, a Roman army commanded by <u>Lucullus</u> was about to begin a battle with <u>Mithridates VI of Pontus</u> when "the sky burst asunder, and a huge, flame-like body was seen to fall between the two armies". Plutarch reports the shape of the object as like a wine-jar (pithos). ^{[28][25]}
AD 65	<u>Sky army</u>	<u>Roman Empire</u> ; <u>Judaea</u>	Romano-Jewish historian <u>Flavius Josephus</u> reported chariots "hurtling through the clouds" prior to the <u>First Jewish–Roman War</u> . ^[25]
AD 196	<u>Angel hair</u>	<u>Roman Empire</u> ; <u>Rome</u> , <u>Italia</u>	Historian Cassius Dio described a "fine rain resembling silver [that] descended from a clear sky upon the Forum of Augustus." He wrote that he was able to plate some of his bronze coins, but four days later, the silvery coating was gone. ^[25]

8th century

Date	Name	Location	Description
AD c. 740	<u>Air ship of Clonmacnoise</u>	<u>Ireland</u> ; <u>Teltown in County Meath</u> , and <u>Clonmacnoise in County Offaly</u>	Several sets of Irish annals, those of Ulster, Tigernach, Clonmacnoise, and the Four Masters, have entries to the effect that " <u>ships with their crews were seen in the air</u> ". ^[29]

16th–17th centuries

Date	Name	Location	Description
1561-04-14	<u>1561 celestial phenomenon over Nuremberg</u>	<u>Holy Roman Empire; Nuremberg, Bavaria</u>	Residents of Nuremberg described an aerial battle, followed by the appearance of "something like a black spear, very long and thick" (translation: Ilse Von Jacobi). A <u>broadsheet</u> recorded that witnesses observed hundreds of spheres, cylinders and other odd-shaped objects that moved erratically overhead. ^[30]
1566-08-07	<u>1566 celestial phenomenon over Basel</u>	<u>Switzerland; Basel, Basel</u>	A broadsheet published in 1566 depicted numerous spherical objects appearing out of the sun. ^[30] The event was recorded and depicted by Samuel Coccius, "a student of the Holy Scripture and of the free arts, at Basel". ^[31]
1609-09-22	<u>Gwanghaegun period UFO Turmoil</u>	<u>Joseon (Korea); Gangwon Province</u>	On September 22, 1609, multiple witnesses in <u>Goseong</u> , <u>Wonju</u> <u>Gangneung</u> , <u>Chuncheon County</u> and <u>Yangyang County</u> described a <u>Halo</u> or <u>washbowl</u> that was divided in two in the sky. ^[32]

19th century

Date	Name	Location	Description
1883-08-12	<u>Bonilla observation</u>	<u>Mexico; Zacatecas Observatory, Zacatecas</u>	On August 12, the astronomer <u>José Bonilla</u> photographed hundreds of dark objects crossing the sun while observing sunspot activity at <u>Zacatecas Observatory</u> in Mexico. Bonilla published an account of the event three years later in <u>L'Astronomie</u> . ^{[33][34]}
1896-11-17 to 1897-04-23	<u>Mystery airships</u>	<u>United States</u>	Newspapers across <u>California</u> , and later other states, especially the Midwest, printed reports of strange <u>airships</u> and lights. Common elements of the descriptions included bright lights, cigar-shaped bodies, movable wings and a metallic hull. ^[35]
1897-04-17	<u>Aurora, Texas, UFO incident</u>	<u>United States; Aurora, Texas</u>	Local correspondent S.E. Hayden reported the crash of an airship piloted by an <u>alien</u> . According to Hayden, the pilot was buried in the local cemetery. Residents of Aurora embrace the story without taking it seriously. ^{[36][37]}

20th century

1900–1949

Date	Name	Location	Description
1904-02-28 ^[38]	USS <i>Supply</i> ^[38]	North Pacific; ^[38] about 300 miles from <u>California</u> ^[39]	While onboard the USS <i>Supply</i> the eighth day after departing from Honolulu where the ship was re-coaled ^[40] three ^[41] crew observed three objects ^[38] "rather bright red" color ^[41] with geometrical formation flight pattern "in-line" and "echelon"; the objects changed course and flightpath changed from the observed horizontal to angularly upwards. ^[38] The duration of reported event was stated as 2 minutes plus. The reporting officer who received the accounts stated all three accounts concurred. ^[41] The ship docked in <u>San Francisco</u> on March 1 1904. ^[40]
1907	Mihal Grameno <u>UFO</u>	<u>Ottoman Empire</u> ; <u>Albania</u>	Mihal Grameno a distinguished Albanian journalist, writer, and activist writes in <i>The Albanian Uprising</i> , "One night, while the fighters of Çerçiz were stationed at the top of a high mountain, a shiny object flew in front of us, stood suspended in the air for several minutes, and then disappeared." ^{[42][43][44]}
1908-06-30	<u>Tunguska event</u>	Russian Empire; near the <u>Podkamennaya Tunguska river</u>	A fireball crossed the sky above Siberia, exploded, and flattened approximately 80 million trees. ^[45] Researchers in the 1950s and 1960s found microscopic silicate and magnetite spheres, consistent with a meteor air burst. ^[46] The area became a drop zone for Soviet rockets launched from <u>Baikonur</u> . In the 2000s, the Tunguska Space Phenomenon, a team of Russian ufologists, explored the area to search for remnants of a supposed alien spaceship, and they may have found pieces of these discarded rocket components. ^{[47][48]}
1909	<u>New Zealand airship sightings</u>	<u>New Zealand</u> ; <u>Otago</u>	In August 1909, moving and whirring lights were reported in the sky around Otago. In the following months, many sightings were reported across New Zealand with varying descriptions of the craft and crew. ^{[49][50][51]}
1917-08-13, 1917-09-13, 1917-10-13	<u>Miracle of the Sun</u>	Portugal; <u>Fátima</u> , <u>Santarém District</u>	Thousands of people gathered in Fátima based on reported Marian apparitions and claimed to see bizarre solar activity. Catholic bishop José Alves Correia da Silva declared the miracle "worthy of belief" on 13 October 1930, and the primarily Catholic witnesses described the event in religious terms. Despite the many photographers present in the crowd, no unusual photo of the sun was captured. Later, Jacques Vallée, Joaquim Fernandes and Fina d'Armada would interpret it as a mass UFO sighting. ^{[52][53][54][55]}
c. 1926	Nicholas Roerich <u>UFO sighting</u>	<u>Tibet</u>	During his Asian expedition, Russian theosophist Nicholas Roerich reported an oval in the sky above his caravan, which was later interpreted as a "flying saucer" by Roerich's Russian followers. ^{[56][57][58]}
1933	Frank Smythe <u>UFO sighting</u>	China–Nepal border; <u>Mount Everest</u> in the <u>Himalayas</u>	On June 1 of the 1933 Mount Everest expedition, Smythe witnessed two spots hovering and pulsating in the sky. ^{[59][60]}
c. 1940s	<u>Foo fighters</u>	<u>Over World War II theaters</u>	During World War II, allied fighter pilots above Europe reported colorful balls of light following their aircraft at high speeds. ^[61]
c. 1941	Cape Girardeau <u>UFO legend</u>	United States; <u>Cape Girardeau</u> , <u>Missouri</u>	A local legend gained wider attention in the 1980s when resident Charlotte Mann claimed in interviews that her father, Reverend William Huffman of the Red Star Baptist Church, had administered last rites for the dying crew of a crashed flying saucer. ^{[62][63][64]}
1942-02-24	<u>Battle of Los Angeles</u>	United States; <u>Los Angeles</u> , <u>California</u>	Just months after the Japanese attack on Pearl Harbor, U.S. radar stations picked up an unidentified aerial object in the early morning. For several hours, anti-aircraft artillery fired thousands of rounds, and the LA Times reported that "the air over Los Angeles erupted like a volcano." ^{[65][66]}